

Flash settings

This one is relatively self explanatory. You can either choose to put the flash in always on mode, where it will fire for every shot, always off mode, where it is permanently switched off or Auto mode, where it will fire depending upon the amount of ambient light and if it thinks the scene is too dark.

Some phones will also have a red-eye reduction mode. You may have seen photos taken with flash often leave bright red spots in people's eyes. This is the result of the light from the flash bouncing off the retina and being captured by the camera. This can only happen if the pupil of the subject's eyes are open wide, so what the red-eye reduction mode does is fire the flash several times before taking a shot with the final flash. The first few flashes will cause the subject's pupils to constrict, so when the final shot is taken you don't end up with red-eyes.



Blind your subjects

Scene settings

Most camera apps these days come with a bunch of preset 'scene' settings meant for various conditions, such as a beach, or a sunset or fireworks or snow. Each of these uses various values of exposure, white balance, ISO, etc. to arrive at a particular setting that the manufacturer thinks would be appropriate for that condition. It's not necessary nor ideal that you use these settings in those conditions. You could try them and see if they work well; photography is all about experimentation after all. But if not, revert to your manual settings and continue as you normally would.